

Phase 1: Prep and Strip the Cable

1. Strip the Outer Jacket Insert the end of your CAT6 cable into the stripping blade slot on your crimping tool (about 1.5 inches from the end). Squeeze the handles gently and spin the tool around the cable once or twice to slice the plastic outer jacket. Pull the cut piece off to expose the internal wires.

Be careful not to press too hard, or you'll accidentally nick the copper wires inside.

2. Deal with the Core Components Once the jacket is off, you will see four twisted pairs of wires wrapped around a central plastic spine (called a spline). Use the flush-cutting blade of your crimper to snip that plastic spine as deep down as possible so it stays out of your way.

Phase 2: Untwist and Organize (T568B Standard)

3. Untwist and Flatten Untwist the four pairs of wires all the way down to the base of the cut jacket. Use your fingers to straighten and flatten the individual wires out as much as possible so they lose their wavy shape.

4. Line Up the Colors Arrange the 8 individual wires side-by-side from **left to right** using the industry-standard **T568B** color sequence:

1. White-Orange
2. Solid Orange
3. White-Green
4. Solid Blue
5. White-Blue
6. Solid Green
7. White-Brown
8. Solid Brown

Phase 3: The Perfect Cut

5. Measure and Trim Gather all 8 flattened wires tightly together between your thumb and forefinger. Hold an RJ45 connector next to them to measure the length: you want the wires to be short enough that the thick outer plastic jacket of the cable will sit safely *inside* the back of the connector when pushed all the way in.

Use the sharp cutting edge of your crimper to make a perfectly clean, straight horizontal cut across all 8 wires. They should be roughly **half an inch** (1.3 cm) long.

Phase 4: Inserting and Crimping

6. Insert into the RJ45 Connector Hold the RJ45 plastic plug with the **locking tab facing down** (away from you) and the gold pins facing up toward your face. Carefully slide your lined-up wires into the back of the plug. Make sure each individual wire stays in its own dedicated track and doesn't jump slots. Push firmly until you see the copper tips of all 8 wires pressing right up against the clear plastic end of the plug.

7. Crimp It Down Insert the prepared plastic plug into the matching 8P (8-position) slot on your RJ45 crimping tool. Squeeze the handles together with a firm, steady motion. The tool will push down the gold teeth into the wires and clamp the rear plastic strain relief over the thick outer jacket.

Relax your grip, remove the cable, and give it a gentle tug to ensure it is locked solidly in place. Repeat the process on the other end, and your custom cable is ready for testing!